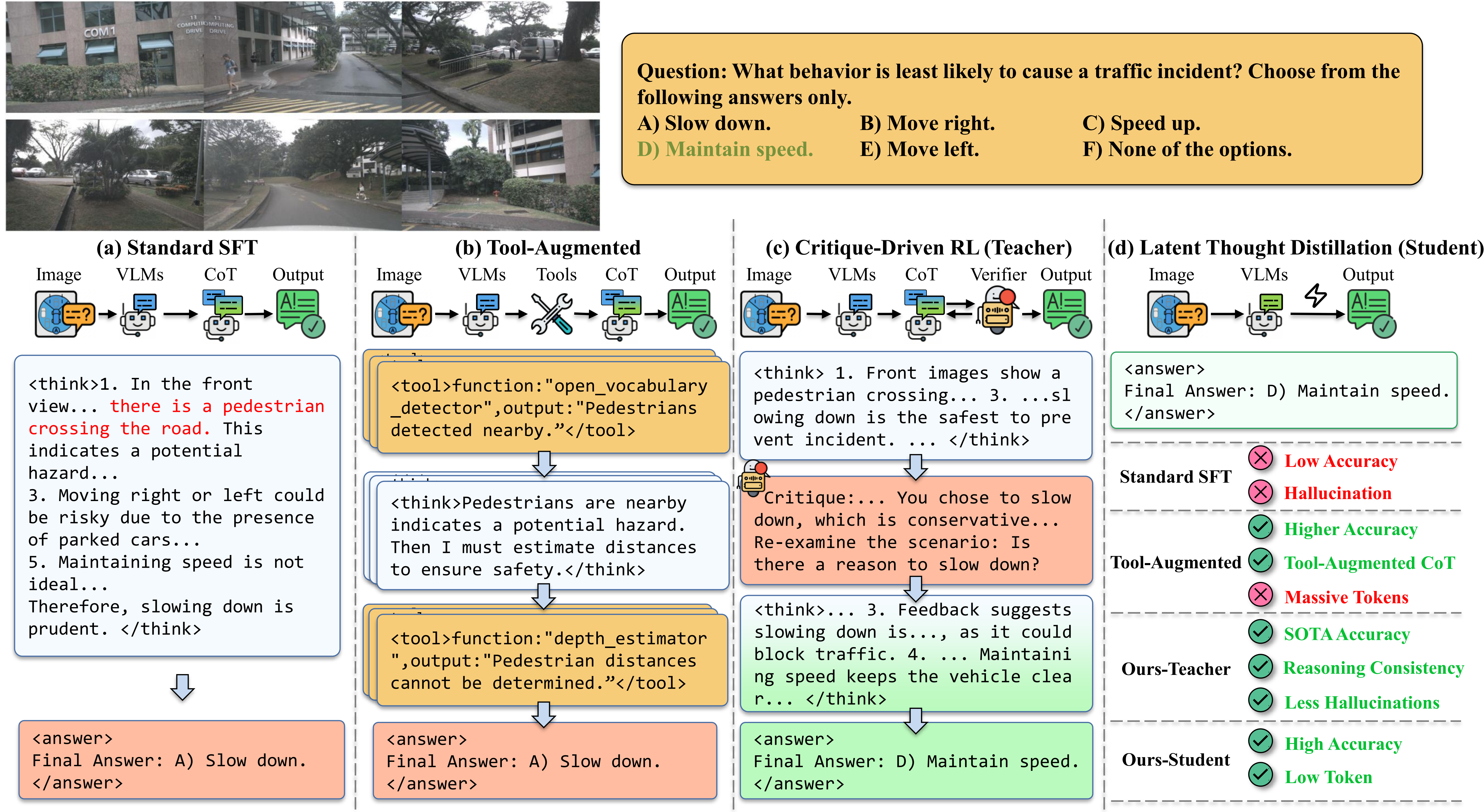

Question: What behavior is least likely to cause a traffic incident? Choose from the following answers only.
A) Slow down.
B) Move right.
C) Speed up.
D) Maintain speed.
E) Move left.
F) None of the options.
(a) Standard SFT
Image
VLMs
CoT
Output
<think>1. In the front view... there is a pedestrian crossing the road. This indicates a potential hazard...
3. Moving right or left could be risky due to the presence of parked cars...
5. Maintaining speed is not ideal...
Therefore, slowing down is prudent. </think>
<answer>
Final Answer: A) Slow down.
</answer>
(b) Tool-Augmented
Image
VLMs
Tools
CoT
Output
<tool>function:"open_vocabulary_detector",output:"Pedestrians detected nearby."</tool>
<think>Pedestrians are nearby indicates a potential hazard. Then I must estimate distances to ensure safety.</think>
<tool>function:"depth_estimator",output:"Pedestrian distances cannot be determined."</tool>
<answer>
Final Answer: A) Slow down.
</answer>
(c) Critique-Driven RL (Teacher)
Image
VLMs
CoT
Verifier
Output
<think> 1. Front images show a pedestrian crossing... 3. ...slowing down is the safest to prevent incident. ... </think>
Critique:... You chose to slow down, which is conservative... Re-examine the scenario: Is there a reason to slow down?
<think>... 3. Feedback suggests slowing down is..., as it could block traffic. 4. ... Maintaining speed keeps the vehicle clear... </think>
<answer>
Final Answer: D) Maintain speed.
</answer>
(d) Latent Thought Distillation (Student)
Image
VLMs
Output
<answer>
Final Answer: D) Maintain speed.
</answer>
Standard SFT
Low Accuracy
Hallucination
Tool-Augmented
Higher Accuracy
Tool-Augmented CoT
Massive Tokens
Ours-Teacher
SOTA Accuracy
Reasoning Consistency
Less Hallucinations
Ours-Student
High Accuracy
Low Token